and demonstrated to me that I was not alone in my sorrow at the SLV-3's failure. "Al your comrades are standing by you," he said. This gave me vital emotional support, encouragement, and guidance.

A post-flight review conducted on 11 August 1979 was attended by more than seventy scientists. A detailed technical appraisal of the failure was completed. Later, the post-flight analysis committee headed by SK Athithan pinpointed the reasons for the malfunction of the vehicle. It was established that the mishap occurred because of the failure of the second stage control system. No control force was available during the second stage flight due to which the vehicle became aerodynamical y unstable, resulting in altitude and velocity loss. This caused the vehicle to fal into the sea even before the other stages could ignite.

Further in-depth analysis of the second-stage failure identified the reason as the draining of a good amount of Red Fuming Nitric Acid (RFNA) used as the oxidizer for the fuel power at that stage. Consequently, when the control force was demanded, only fuel was injected resulting in zero force. 'A solenoid valve in the oxidizer tank remaining open due to contamination after the first command at T-8